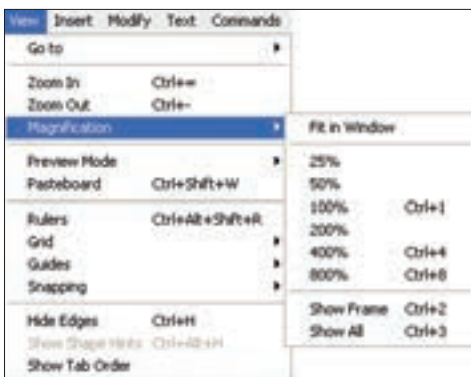


1.2 The Stage

The Stage is the visual workspace, or the Document Window, of Flash CS3. It is the large white space that is seen at the center of the workspace, and is like a blank space or a frame where you can insert text, images and graphics. You can also call it the composing canvas of Flash CS3. You can import and animate various elements on to this Stage. The gray area that you see outside the Stage is called the Off Stage area. To view the Off Stage area you must check the Pasteboard option from the “View” drop-down menu: View > Pasteboard. By default, the Pasteboard option is checked, so unless you un-checked it earlier, you don’t need to do anything to view it. You can easily place graphics in the Off Stage area if the Pasteboard is on. The default Stage size in Flash CS3 is 550 x 400 pixels. With resolutions being what they are these days, you might need to change this size. You can just insert the desired value into the Properties panel. By changing the Zoom percentage beside the Workspace option, you can change

the view of the Stage size. You can either select a preset zoom percentage from the drop-down menu, or just type the value in the field.

A single function can be done in various ways in Flash CS3. We can Zoom in or Zoom out the Stage from the View drop down menu:



View Drop Down menu

View > Zoom In

View > Zoom Out

You can also select the Zoom Tool of the Toolbar and then drag the particular section of the Stage to either Zoom in or Zoom out.